

## Phishing & Common Cyber Attacks

Una Guía para Protegerte en Línea

### What is Phishing?

**Phishing** is a social engineering attack where cybercriminals send deceptive emails or messages designed to trick you into revealing sensitive information. They often masquerade as trusted entities (like your bank, government agencies, or popular services like Netflix) to steal passwords, financial details, or personal data.

### How to Spot a Phishing Attack

- **Urgent or Threatening Language:** Phrases like *"Your account will be suspended immediately"* are designed to trigger panic.
- **Generic Greetings:** Using *"Dear Customer"* instead of your actual name.
- **Mismatched Sender Addresses:** The email displays "PayPal Support", but the actual address is *security@paypal-update123.com*.
- **Suspicious Links (Homograph Attacks):** Links that look legitimate but contain slight typos (e.g., *amazon.com* vs *arnazon.com*). Always hover over links before clicking.

### The Golden Rules of Protection

- **Never click links in unexpected emails.** Navigate to the website manually by typing the URL in your browser.
- **Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).** Even if a hacker steals your password, they cannot access your account without the second factor (like an authenticator app code).
- **Use a Password Manager.** They generate impossible-to-guess passwords and will refuse to auto-fill your credentials on a fake phishing website.

### Public Wi-Fi & Network Security

When connecting to public Wi-Fi (coffee shops, airports), your data can be intercepted by anyone on the same network. **Never access banking or sensitive accounts on public Wi-Fi** unless you are using a trusted VPN (Virtual Private Network). A VPN encrypts your traffic, creating a secure tunnel that hackers cannot see into.

### Ransomware & Malware

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~~Ransomware encrypts all your personal files and demands payment for the decryption key. Malware operates silently to steal your data or resources.~~

**Defense Strategy:** Keep your Operating System and apps updated. Updates contain critical security patches. Most importantly, maintain regular, offline backups of your most important files using an external hard drive. If you get infected, you can wipe your computer and restore your files for free.

## Social Engineering: The Human Element

Hackers know that breaking into a computer is hard, but tricking a human is easy. Be skeptical of unsolicited phone calls claiming to be from 'Microsoft Tech Support' or your bank asking for verification codes. A legitimate company will **never** ask for your password or a 2FA code over the phone.